

The History Department

YEAR 7 SCHEME OF WORK (2026-2027)

Curriculum Planning & Lesson Companion

Key Stage 3 Curriculum Intent & Pedagogical Architecture

1. Curriculum Rationale & Local Maritime Heritage

Our Key Stage 3 history curriculum is intentionally constructed to link national and global historical narratives with the distinctive maritime geography and lived environment of The History Portal pupils. From the industrial revolution of the Fareham ironmaster (Henry Cort at Funtley) to the strategic supremacy of Portsmouth Royal Dockyard and the profound sacrifices recorded on the Stubbington village war memorials, history is made tangible, relevant, and deeply rooted in our coastal community.

2. Disciplinary Progression & Historical Enquiry

Across Years 7, 8, and 9, disciplinary thinking progresses sequentially to secure the foundational skills required for GCSE excellence:

- **Chronological Rigour & Global Encounters:** De-centering traditional anglocentric narratives by examining early global trade, Indigenous perspectives in Australia, and African resistance to the Transatlantic Slave Trade alongside British social transformations.
- **Causation & Consequence:** Moving from simple direct triggers in Year 7 to evaluating multi-tiered, long-term geopolitical catalysts (e.g. European alliance systems, naval arms races).
- **Source Utility & Forensic Evidence:** Progressing from basic comprehension to rigorous interrogation of provenance, evaluating authorial motive, audience, and historical reliability.
- **Historiographical Debate:** Engaging pupils with active academic debates (e.g., assessing the Magna Carta, or challenging the 'Lions led by Donkeys' narrative of the Great War) grounded in historical evidence.

3. Adaptive Teaching, Dual Coding & Inclusion

Pupils work through bespoke printed A4 workbooks closely paired with our digital learning portal. Standardized PEE/PEEL Structure Strips, Causal Connective Banks, consistent dual coding, and digital accessibility features offload working memory, ensuring all SEND and lower-attaining pupils achieve ambitious historical progress with zero cognitive overload.

KS3: Water and Sanitation Through Time

Year 7 | Why did it take so long to clean up Britain?

🌀 SPIRAL CURRICULUM THEMATIC STRANDS (VERTICAL DISCIPLINARY PROGRESSION) CHRISTINE COUNSELL CURRICULAR THREADS

PUBLIC HEALTH & STATE POWER

Roman civic governance → Medieval municipal neglect → 1848 Public Health Act (L1, L2, L4)

SANITARY ENGINEERING & TECH

Roman aqueducts → Lead piping → Bazalgette's brick sewer network (L1, L6)

ETIOLOGY & SCIENTIFIC EMPIRICISM

Divine retribution & Miasma → John Snow's Broad St map → Germ Theory (L3, L5)

WORKING-CLASS ACTIVISM & RIGHTS

Polluted town riots → Water rate strikes → Public demand for health infrastructure (L2, L4)

Lesson Number & Title

Learning Objectives & Enquiry

Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment

Lesson 1

How much progress did the Romans make in public health?

CHANGE & CONTINUITY

- Understand how Roman engineers used gravity conduits and aqueducts to transport freshwater into towns.
- Analyze the social and hygienic function of Roman public bathhouses (thermae) and latrines.
- Evaluate why Roman public health infrastructure collapsed after the withdrawal of the legions in AD 410.

Hinge Q: How did Roman engineers ensure millions of gallons of water flowed continuously over tens of miles without mechanical pumps?

📄 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:

Housesteads Fort Roman communal latrines (Hadrian's Wall); Seneca's moral treatise on Roman baths; Fishbourne Roman Palace mosaics

🗣️ DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:

Roman engineering triumphalism vs lived public health reality: lead piping & parasite transmission

📝 CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:

[Evaluative Enquiry] To what extent was Roman public health driven by imperial prestige and military efficiency rather than genuine medical understanding?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 2 Why did public health decline during the Middle Ages?  HISTORICAL EVIDENCE & MONASTIC LIFE	- Identify the structural waste problems created by expanding walled medieval boroughs. - Analyze how medieval town councils employed specialized workers to manage refuse and sewage. - Evaluate the public health consequences of the Black Death and the 1388 Statute of Cambridge. <i>Hinge Q: Why did medieval town walls make waste management significantly more difficult than in open rural villages?</i>	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Canterbury Cathedral Waterworks Plan (c. 1165); City of London Sanitary Ordinance of 1357; Monastic reredorter latrine architecture  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Medieval hygiene myths: Religious purity and monastic engineering vs urban municipal paralysis  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Evaluative Enquiry] How far is it historically accurate to describe medieval towns as completely filthy and devoid of sanitation rules?
Lesson 3 To what extent did towns become filthier during the Early Modern period?  CAUSATION & ETIOLOGICAL BELIEFS	- Understand how the demographic explosion of Tudor and Stuart London caused urban squalor to worsen. - Analyze why Sir John Harington's 1596 water closet was an immediate commercial failure. - Evaluate primary source dispatches from Samuel Pepys and the Great Plague of 1665. <i>Hinge Q: Why did London's rapid population growth outpace the capacity of traditional gong farmers and cesspits?</i>	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Sir John Harington's 1596 'Ajax' Toilet Diagram; Samuel Pepys' 1660 Diary on cellar privies; The Cowdray Engraving of Tudor Portsmouth (1545)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Laissez-faire policy debate & Roy Porter on early modern infrastructure limits; technological innovation vs municipal failure  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Evaluative Enquiry] Why did town sanitation fail to improve significantly between 1500 and 1750 despite technological inventions?
Lesson 4 How did the Industrial Revolution lead to a public health crisis?  HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE & STATE INTERVENTION	- Understand how the Industrial Revolution generated unprecedented urban overcrowding and filth. - Analyze how Asiatic Cholera terrorized Victorian society and exposed sanitary failure. - Evaluate Edwin Chadwick's 1842 Report and the political opposition rooted in laissez-faire. <i>Hinge Q: Why did private speculative builders construct back-to-back houses without through-ventilation or private yards?</i>	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Chadwick's 1842 Report on the Sanitary Condition of the Labouring Population; Dr John Snow's Broad Street Cholera Spot Map (1854); Portsmouth cholera burial registers  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Industrial urbanisation: Miasma theory vs early contagionist epidemiology; laissez-faire vs state health intervention  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Evaluative Enquiry] Why did the British government adhere to "laissez-faire" while thousands perished from cholera in industrial slums?
Lesson 5 Why did it take the "Great Stink" to finally clean up Britain's streets?  SOURCE UTILITY & EPIDEMIOLOGICAL MAPPING	- Understand how the installation of domestic flush toilets turned the Thames into an open, toxic sewer. - Analyze how the heatwave of 1858 paralyzed the House of Commons and forced emergency legislation. - Evaluate the scale and significance of Joseph Bazalgette's underground intercepting sewer system. <i>Hinge Q: Why did replacing backyard cesspools with water closets accidentally make the River Thames lethally toxic?</i>	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Punch Cartoon 'The Silent Highwayman' (1858 Great Stink); Bazalgette's Victorian intercepting sewer blueprints (1859–1865); Source A: Punch Cartoon: "Father Thames Introducing His Offspring to London" (1858)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: The Great Stink of 1858: Parliamentary self-interest and physical stench vs municipal laissez-faire ideology  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Evaluative Enquiry] How far was the building of London's sewer system driven by political panic and self-preservation rather than altruism for the poor?
Lesson 6 Why did it take the scientific revolution of Germ Theory to finally conquer water-borne disease?  TURNING POINT ANALYSIS & CIVIL ENGINEERING	- Understand Dr. John Snow's hypothesis that cholera was an ingested water-borne poison rather than an airborne miasma. - Analyze the forensic methodology of Snow's 1854 Spot Map and the Broad Street pump handle removal. - Evaluate why the medical establishment resisted Snow's discovery and explain how Germ Theory and the 1875 Act conquered cholera. <i>Hinge Q: Why did cholera's biological symptoms (vomiting and diarrhea) lead John Snow to deduce that the poison was swallowed, not inhaled?</i>	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Dr John Snow's 1854 Broad Street Cholera Spot Map; Soho mortality records & Eley Brothers percussion cap factory logs; Source A: Dr. John Snow's Original 1854 Cholera Spot Map of Soho, London  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Snow's empirical epidemiological mapping vs the entrenched medical establishment and Board of Health  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Evaluative Enquiry] Why was John Snow's discovery of the cause of cholera initially rejected in 1854, and what finally forced Britain to clean up its water supply by 1875?

KS3: Medieval England & The Struggle for Power (1066–1485)

Year 7 | How did power shift in Medieval England?

🌀 SPIRAL CURRICULUM THEMATIC STRANDS (VERTICAL DISCIPLINARY PROGRESSION) CHRISTINE COUNSELL CURRICULAR THREADS

MONARCHY, LAW & STATE POWER

Norman conquest autocracy → Royal justice & Clarendon → Magna Carta & Dynastic collapse (L1–L4, L8)

FEUDAL ECONOMY & MILITARY TECH

Motte-and-bailey engineering → Domesday land audit → Post-plague market economy (L1, L2, L5, L6)

CATHOLIC HEGEMONY & IDEOLOGY

Papal supremacy & Becket martyrdom → Doom paintings & tithes → Divine plague etiology (L3, L5, L6)

POPULAR & BARONIAL RESISTANCE

Saxon rebellions & Hereward → Runnymede baronial revolt → 1381 Peasants' March on London (L2, L4, L7)

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 1 Lesson 1: 1066 - Why did three men claim one throne, and how did William win?  CAUSATION (1066 SUCCESSION CRISIS)	- Explain why there was a succession crisis in 1066 and evaluate the claims of the three rivals. - Analyze the sequence of events leading up to the Battle of Hastings. - Evaluate the reasons for William's victory at the Battle of Hastings. <i>Hinge Q: If you were the Witan, whose claim would you support and why?</i>	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The Anglo-Saxon Chronicle for the year 1066; Source B: The Bayeux Tapestry; Source C: The Battle of Hastings (19th Century)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Explain why there was a succession crisis in 1066 and evaluate the claims of the three rivals.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Task 1: The Claimants' Pitch (Group Battle) Imagine you are an adviser to the Witan (the council of English lords) in January 1066. Write a short persuasive speech (3–4 sen...
Lesson 2 Lesson 2: Castles, Terror, and the Domesday Book - How did William control England?  HISTORICAL EVIDENCE (BAYEUX TAPESTRY)	- Understand how the motte and bailey castle design allowed Normans to quickly establish military dominance. - Evaluate the causes and devastating consequences of the Harrying of the North. - Analyze the purpose and impact of the Domesday Book using local Hampshire records. <i>Hinge Q: Hinge Question: Why was it essential for early Norman castles to be built from wood and earth rather than stone?</i>	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source C: An extract from the Ecclesiastical History by the Anglo-Norman monk and chronicler Orderic Vitalis.; Source D: An extract from the Anglo-Saxon Chronicle, written by contemporary English monks.  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the causes and devastating consequences of the Harrying of the North.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Task 2: Explain why William carried out the Harrying of the North and what the consequences were for the people living in the region.
Lesson 3 Lesson 3: Crown vs Church: Why did Henry II clash with Thomas Becket?  SIGNIFICANCE & STATE CONTROL (DOMESDAY BOOK)	- Understand Henry II's motives for appointing Thomas Becket as Archbishop of Canterbury. - Evaluate the reasons for the complete breakdown in relations between Henry and Becket. - Analyze the events of the murder in 1170 and its aftermath. <i>Hinge Q: Hinge Question: Why did Henry believe that appointing his best friend would solve the problem of 'criminous clerks'?</i>	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Extract from a letter sent by Thomas Becket in French exile to King Henry II, c. 1166; Extract from the chronicle of Edward Grim, c. 1174–1177  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the reasons for the complete breakdown in relations between Henry and Becket.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Task 2: Explain the main reasons why the relationship between King Henry II and Archbishop Thomas Becket broke down completely between 1162 and 1164.

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 4 Lesson 4: Magna Carta (1215): A triumph of liberty or a selfish baronial power grab?  CHANGE & CONTINUITY (FEUDAL STRUCTURE)	- Understand the multiple reasons for the barons' anger towards King John by 1215. - Analyze the key clauses of Magna Carta and how they limited absolute royal power. - Evaluate whether Magna Carta was a triumph of liberty or a selfish baronial power grab. Hinge Q: Hinge Question: Why did the combination of military failure and religious crisis make John's financial extortion so unbearable for the barons?	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Extract from Clause 39 of the Magna Carta, June 1215; Adapted from modern historical scholarship on the 1215 settlement  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Historical Interpretations: The Magna Carta  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Task 3: The Trial of King John (Interpretation) Divide your answer into two parts: 1. You are King John's defense lawyer. Write a short paragraph defending his actions, exp...
Lesson 5 Lesson 5: Doom Paintings and Tithes: What was life like in a medieval village?  INTERPRETATIONS & CONSTITUTIONAL LAW (MAGNA CARTA)	- Understand the daily agricultural routine and living conditions of a medieval villein. - Explain how the Catholic Church maintained absolute control over peasant life. Hinge Q: Hinge Question: Look at Source A. How does the artist use placement (foreground vs background) to show who holds the power?	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: A depiction of a busy medieval parish church.; Source B: A medieval record detailing the collection of church tithes from peasant families.; Source C: The famous medieval Doom Painting at Chaldon Church, Surrey, dating from around 1200.  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Core Disciplinary Concept: Historical Enquiry & Causal Argumentation  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Task 2: Describe what a tithe was, how it was collected, and why it caused tension between ordinary medieval peasants and the Church.
Lesson 6 Lesson 6: 1348: How did the Black Death shatter medieval social order?  CAUSATION & CONSEQUENCE (THE BLACK DEATH)	- Understand why the medieval population was medically and socially defenseless against the Black Death in 1348. - Explain how the severe labor shortage shifted economic power from the nobility to the peasantry. - Analyze the long-term structural and psychological breakdown of the feudal system. Hinge Q: Hinge Question: Why did the medieval belief that the plague was a punishment from God actually make the outbreak spread faster?	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Extract from the Statute of Labourers, 1351  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Core Disciplinary Concept: Historical Enquiry & Causal Argumentation  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Task 2: Explain how the Black Death transformed the balance of economic power between lords and peasants after 1348.
Lesson 7 Lesson 7: 1381: Why did the Peasants revolt, and did they achieve anything?  CAUSATION & CONSEQUENCE	- Identify the long-term economic and short-term political causes of the Peasants' Revolt. - Analyze the extent of the threat posed by the rebels when they captured London. - Evaluate the immediate outcome and long-term consequences of the revolt. Hinge Q: Hinge Question: Why was the 1380 Poll Tax considered far more unfair than traditional medieval taxes?	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Extract from a sermon by John Ball, recorded in Jean Froissart's Chronicles  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Analyze the extent of the threat posed by the rebels when they captured London.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Task 2: How much of a threat did the rebels actually pose to King Richard II and royal government when they seized London in June 1381?
Lesson 8 Lesson 8: The Wars of the Roses (1455–1485) – How did the medieval era end in blood?  CAUSATION & CONSEQUENCE	- Explain the causes of the Wars of the Roses and the division between Lancaster and York. - Understand the significance of the Battle of Bosworth in ending the medieval era. Hinge Q: Hinge Question: Look at Source A. Why is it dangerous for historians to rely on this painting for factual evidence?	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: An extract from the contemporary account 'How Richard III Made Himself King' by the Italian traveler Dominic Mancini, written in the summer of 1483.; Source B: A portrait of King Richard III, painted by an unknown artist in the sixteenth century.  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Core Disciplinary Concept: Historical Enquiry & Causal Argumentation  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 9 Lesson 9: Assessment: How powerful was a medieval monarch?  HISTORICAL ENQUIRY & ANALYSIS	- To accurately sequence the key events of the medieval period. - To evaluate differing historical interpretations of medieval royal power. - To write a structured essay explaining the decline of royal power. <i>Hinge Q: Which event directly caused the severe labour shortage that eventually led to the Peasants' Revolt?</i>	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Interpretation A: A modern historian writing about the early Norman period.; Interpretation B: A modern historian writing about the Later Middle Ages.  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: To evaluate differing historical interpretations of medieval royal power.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Task 1: Which of the two interpretations do you find more convincing? Explain your answer using your own knowledge.
Unit Key Vocabulary: Power • Claim • Conquest • Anglo-Saxon • Significance • Feudal system • Resistance • Propaganda • Domesday Book • Motte-and-bailey • Church • Monarchy • Martyr • Excommunication • Canon law • Magna Carta • Democracy • Parliament • Interpretation • Baron • Peasantry • Tithe • Feudalism • Serf • Strip farming • Black Death • Change • Labour shortage • Statute of Labourers • Social order • Revolt • Poll tax • Wat Tyler • Villeinage • Dynasty • Usurper • Synthesis • Evidence • Judgement		